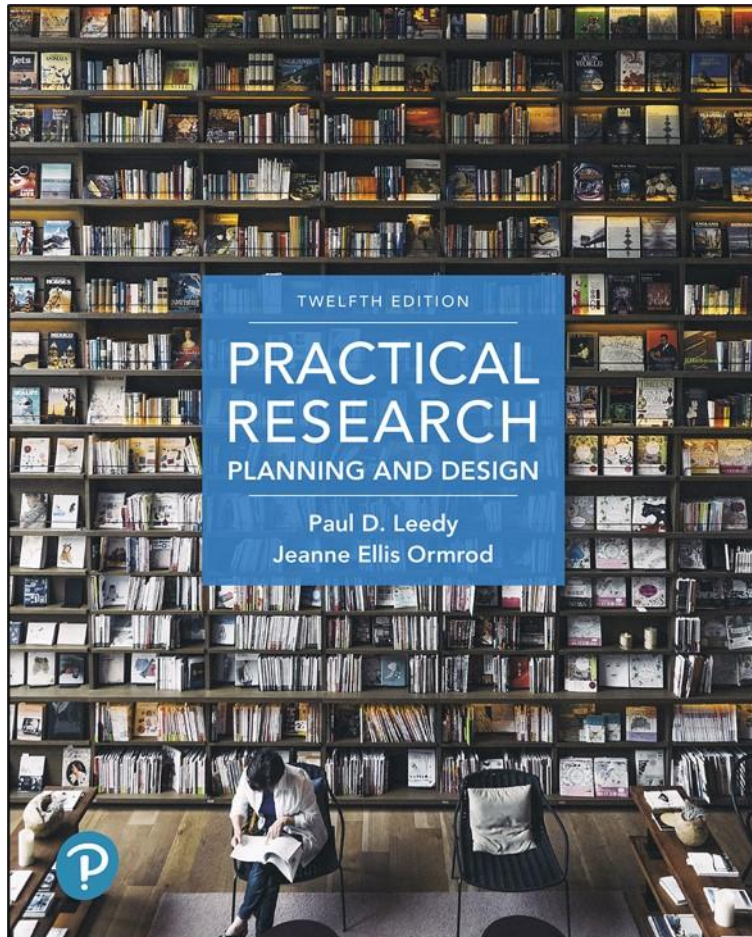


Practical Research: Planning and Design

Twelfth Edition



Chapter 9

Mixed Methods Designs

Mixed Methods Designs (1 of 3)

- Integration of quantitative and qualitative data
- Most useful when addressing the research problem requires both types of data

Mixed Methods Designs (2 of 3)

- Mixed Methods Researchers should be well-versed in:
 1. Identifying focused and useful research questions
 2. Formulating and strategically testing hypotheses
 3. Choosing one or more samples that enable appropriate inferences about a larger population
 4. Controlling for confounding variables
 5. Creating and using assessment instruments that have validity and reliability for their purposes

Mixed Methods Designs (3 of 3)

- Mixed Methods Researchers should be well-versed in:
5. Conducting structured, semistructured, and open-ended interviews
 6. Analyzing qualitative data
 7. Calculating and drawing inferences from descriptive and inferential statistics
 8. Drawing and persuasively arguing for reasonable conclusions from qualitative data

When Mixed-Methods Designs are Most Useful and Appropriate

- Several good reasons for mixed methods research:
 - Completeness
 - Complementarity
 - Hypothesis generation and testing
 - Development of appropriate research tools and strategies
 - Resolution of puzzling findings
 - Triangulation

General Categories of Mixed-Methods Research (1 of 4)

- **Convergent designs**
 - Qualitative and quantitative data collected together, equally weighted
 - Often take a QUAN + QUAL form
 - Can also take an approach that more heavily favors either quant or qual

General Categories of Mixed-Methods Research (2 of 4)

- **Exploratory sequential designs**
 - Qualitative phase to get a general sense of the phenomenon first
 - More systematic, quantitative phase based on qualitative data
- **Explanatory sequential designs**
 - Quantitative phase first
 - Qualitative phase for exploration of quantitative results

General Categories of Mixed-Methods Research (3 of 4)

- Longitudinal Mixed-Methods Designs
 - Longitudinal studies (recall from chapter 6) follow a single group of participants for two or more occasions over a lengthy time period, perhaps over the course of several months or years.
 - Longitudinal mixed-methods designs incorporate both qualitative and quantitative data collection over a long period of time.

General Categories of Mixed-Methods Research (4 of 4)

- Multiphase iterative designs
 - Three or more phases
 - Foundational data early
 - Later phases build on early data
 - Example: Program evaluation
 - Baseline data
 - Intervention
 - Data: Did the intervention work
 - Modify the intervention
 - Data: Did the modifications work

Planning a Mixed-Methods Study (1 of 2)

- Identify research questions and hypotheses
 - should require different types of data
- Begin a literature review
 - May require revision and additions as the study emerges
- Choose appropriate samples
 - Independent
 - Linked

Planning a Mixed-Methods Study (2 of 2)

- Ensure credibility of the overall research effort
- Consider special ethical issues
 - may need more than one institutional review
 - may need to ensure consent for follow-up phases

Analyzing and Interpreting Mixed-Methods Data

- Two important considerations:
 - How to weight quantitative and qualitative data when drawing conclusions
 - How to integrate quantitative and qualitative findings for interpretation

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